

BeeAware: Application Usage Monitoring and Time Management System for Habit Improvement

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Abstract—
Index Terms—

I. INTRODUCTION

The global digital landscape has transformed personal computers into double-edged instruments of unprecedented economic productivity and relentless cognitive fragmentation. Globally, digital consumption has surged dramatically, with users averaging nearly seven hours of daily internet exposure spent navigating algorithmically optimized digital ecosystems [6], [11]. This continuous connectivity has given rise to a global attention economy that engineered platforms to systematically exploit human cognitive vulnerabilities, resulting in a documented decline in individual attention spans and psychological well-being [1], [10]. Modern workspaces frequently demand prolonged interaction with digital screens, yet these environments expose users to perpetual interruptions, inducing a state of chronic task-switching and cognitive fatigue [19]. This tension underscores a critical problem in Human-Computer Interaction (HCI): while digital connectivity is mandatory for modern workflows, it simultaneously degrades the focused concentration required to execute high-value cognitive tasks [12].

In the national context of the Philippines, these digital dependencies severely stress emerging remote working and hybrid academic paradigms. Recent regional metrics show that the typical Filipino internet user maintains some of the highest daily media consumption rates globally, a trend that directly mirrors a sharp inflation in smartphone and internet dependency among students and the white-collar workforce [11]. While this hyper-connectivity supports the country's booming digital labor market, it introduces a severe systemic vulnerability: high-frequency digital distractions are closely linked to escalating rates of academic procrastination, psychological distress, and a notable drop in overall academic performance [8], [9], [20]. This digital disruption limits professional efficacy and destabilizes work-life balance within domestic environments, threatening organizational commitment across local public and private sectors [13]. Consequently, there is an urgent national need for scalable, localized tools that can protect productivity without compromising user privacy.

At the immediate local level, this crisis is visibly apparent within regional educational and administrative infrastructures.

Regional directives, such as the Department of Education (DepEd) Davao Region Strategic Plan, have explicitly prioritized digital literacy alongside the cultivation of responsible digital citizenship to mitigate the erosion of student study habits caused by mobile phone and desktop dependencies [4], [5]. However, existing digital time-management interventions fall short of these objectives. Commercial tracking tools like RescueTime or Apple Screen Time operate on passive, historical charting mechanics that provide retroactive awareness rather than real-time behavioral guidance [33]. Furthermore, these systems require users to manually input and categorize their activities—a tedious administrative hurdle that often leads to rapid user abandonment [7]. More critically, modern users are increasingly hesitant to adopt tracking utilities that exfiltrate sensitive, second-by-second desktop logs to external cloud servers, creating a fundamental tension between productivity logging and individual data privacy.

To bridge these gaps, this paper presents **BeeAware**, a localized, privacy-preserving edge-AI tracking and behavioral coaching ecosystem. Built on the six phases of the Cross-Industry Standard Process for Data Mining (CRISP-DM) framework, BeeAware transforms passive operating system telemetry into active behavioral interventions. The core architecture automatically intercepts active window title text streams and classifies them across the four quadrants of the Eisenhower Matrix—Urgent/Important (Deep Work), Urgent/Not Important (Reactive Noise), Not Urgent/Important (Strategic Planning), and Not Urgent/Not Important (Distraction)—mitigating the cognitive biases that lead individuals to prioritize short-term trivialities over long-term goals [3], [25]. By executing text feature extraction via Term Frequency-Inverse Document Frequency (TF-IDF) alongside a localized, lightweight margin classifier, BeeAware delivers real-time, context-aware push notifications to gently nudge users back toward their intended workflows [14], [37]. Crucially, the entire machine learning inference loop executes locally on the host machine, ensuring absolute data privacy.

The principal contributions of this research are structured as follows:

- **Privacy-Preserving Edge Architecture:** We design and implement a zero-cloud, client-side tracking system that processes low-level operating system telemetry entirely within local runtime boundaries, eliminating external data

vulnerability risks.

- **Context-Aware Multi-Class Classification:** We develop a lightweight Natural Language Processing (NLP) pipeline optimized for high-dimensional, short-text window titles to dynamically map active user states into behavioral matrix coordinates.
- **Real-Time Persuasive Intervention Engine:** We integrate a localized feedback mechanism that translates real-time classification changes into non-intrusive behavioral nudges, encouraging sustainable habit formation.
- **Empirical Usability Evaluation:** We validate the system’s operational viability and user acceptance through structured System Usability Scale (SUS) assessments within a live environment [31], [34].

II. RELATED WORK

A. The Digital Attention Crisis and Global Productivity Paradox

The modern digital landscape is increasingly defined by the attention it garners, where software applications are systematically engineered to maximize user engagement through psychological means [1], [10]. While digital technologies are initially deployed as catalysts for organizational and personal efficiency, their invasive nature often triggers a phenomenon known as the “productivity paradox” [33]. Empirical observations reveal that the average user checks their personal device over 96 times a day, frequently falling into a digital “rabbit hole” that consumes hours of non-essential time on superficial media platforms [12]. A primary research gap identified on a global scale is the lack of active intervention systems within consumer software design; although users maintain an abstract awareness of their soaring screen-time metrics, they lack the real-time, structured feedback mechanisms required to disrupt deeply ingrained, destructive behavioral habits [14], [37].

B. National and Regional Context: Digital Literacy and Fatigue

This attention crisis manifests with heightened severity within the Philippines, which continually registers as a global leader in digital media consumption. Empirical reporting indicates that the average daily internet exposure among the domestic population exceeds 10 hours [11]. This high level of connectivity frequently correlates with adverse behavioral and psychological outcomes. Academic dependencies on mobile devices and personal computers significantly contribute to distracted study habits, reduced cognitive focus, and prolonged cycles of academic and professional procrastination [5], [9], [20].

On a regional scale within Mindanao, studies at institutions such as Mindanao State University (MSU) Marawi have further documented a significant correlation between social media over-dependency and severe academic performance drops among students [8]. Furthermore, within expanding urban centers like Davao City and the Northern Mindanao region, the sudden transition to digital-first workflows has

introduced widespread digital fatigue [13]. In these environments, the system-level inability to distinguish between high-priority workplace operations and low-priority social notifications leads to decreased job satisfaction and emotional burnout [13]. While regional educational bodies have initiated strategic directives, such as the Department of Education (DepEd) Davao Region Strategic Plan, these programs remain pedagogical and instructional rather than technological [4]. This leaves a critical vacancy for automated systems capable of actively managing and mitigating these digital habits at the hardware interface level.

C. Limitations of Existing Digital Well-Being Tools

Current market leaders, such as Apple Screen Time and Android Digital Wellbeing, provide what is categorized in human-computer interaction (HCI) literature as “passive reporting” [33]. These utility frameworks focus strictly on aggregating historical usage data and executing binary application blocking. However, behavioral studies suggest that these rigid, restrictive-only models often induce heightened user frustration or trigger a “rebound usage” effect, wherein users over-consume distracting media or abandon the tool entirely once the artificial time block expires [7], [10]. Furthermore, comparative analyses show that existing tools lack contextual intelligence. They quantify productivity using broad, hard-coded application categories but fail to recognize when a user is spending excessive time on low-priority tasks within a otherwise productive environment (such as a browser tab running non-essential streams), highlighting the necessity for a nuanced, importance-based classification framework.

D. The Eisenhower Matrix as a Classification Framework

To establish an objective multi-class target space, researchers leverage the Eisenhower Matrix—a classic task-management tool that categorizes activities into a four-quadrant grid predicated on the distinct thresholds of urgency (tasks demanding immediate reaction) and importance (tasks aligning with long-term missions) [3]. In contemporary tracking applications, these quadrants are mapped to distinct behavioral states: Q1 (Urgent & Important; Crisis/Do), Q2 (Not Urgent & Important; Growth/Plan), Q3 (Urgent & Not Important; Noise/Interruptions), and Q4 (Neither Urgent nor Important; Play/Distractions). The effectiveness of this matrix lies in its mathematical capacity to mitigate the “mere-urgency effect,” a cognitive bias where individuals systematically prioritize short-term urgent tasks over high-value important ones, regardless of their objective long-term outcomes [25]. By combining this psychological model with algorithmic classification, workstations can automate honest task evaluation, combat decision fatigue, and actively guide users toward highly productive Q2 behaviors.

E. Edge Computing and Webcam-Based Workstation Monitoring

The use of webcam-based presence detection for workstation monitoring has gained significant traction, driven by the

need for real-time occupancy data without relying on intrusive or high-cost external hardware arrays. MediaPipe provides a robust, cross-platform framework for building perception pipelines capable of running single-shot face detection models at sub-millisecond latency directly on a local CPU or GPU [21], [35]. These facial landmark detection approaches remain highly robust under background deployment conditions, maintaining an accuracy profile exceeding 97% across diverse ambient lighting conditions with minimal computational overhead on consumer-grade machines [35], [36]. Crucially, local edge execution serves as the privacy-preserving gold standard in ambient monitoring [23]; because all frames are processed locally and pixel data is immediately discarded post-inference, raw image files never leave the local machine, matching the strict privacy constraints of the *BeeAware* system architecture.

F. TF-IDF Feature Space and Linear Support Vector Classifiers

Extracting contextual intent from unstructured, high-dimensional short text—such as operating system window titles or browser tab strings—remains a fundamental challenge in context-aware computing [17]. To overcome this, text processing pipelines employ Term Frequency-Inverse Document Frequency (TF-IDF) combined with n -gram vectorization as a statistical filtering engine [18]. TF-IDF assigns heavy statistical weights to high-signal, context-heavy keywords (e.g., `PostgreSQL`, `GitLab`) while suppressing low-signal, generic terms, enabling systems to accurately isolate a user’s semantic intent [18].

When text is converted into these sparse, high-dimensional vector spaces, traditional models like Decision Trees often struggle with overfitting or intensive compute overhead. Conversely, a Linear Support Vector Classifier (Linear SVC) is highly optimal for text classification due to its innate mathematical ability to seamlessly manage sparse features while maintaining robust generalization boundaries [29]. Because short text headers are frequently linearly separable in high-dimensional domains, a linear kernel offers rapid training and sub-millisecond inference capabilities [29]. This allows a multi-class Linear SVC to establish predictable, immediate decision boundaries between specific digital tasks and their corresponding Eisenhower quadrant assignments without exhausting host workstation resources [30].

G. The Role of Custom-Labeled Corpora in Domain-Specific NLP

A fundamental barrier in natural language processing is the semantic gap between generic vocabulary and domain-specific intent. Off-the-shelf text datasets consistently underperform when tracking specialized workflows, causing classifiers to misinterpret technical system titles (e.g., `VSCode`, `localhost`) as generic noise or misclassifying their urgency thresholds [26], [28]. Consequently, the assembly of a localized, custom-labeled corpus is a recognized prerequisite for training supervised classifiers to recognize unique workflow signatures [26]. A manually curated corpus serves as the

empirical ground truth that guides the TF-IDF vectorizer to position optimal decision boundaries [27]. By explicitly pairing local technical strings with targeted psychological indicators (e.g., pairing `System Error` with Q1 and `Social Media` with Q4), the resulting domain-specific corpus provides the multidimensional context required for an AI model to operate efficiently as a real-time behavioral coach [26].

H. Interactive Dashboards and the Intention-Behavior Gap

Accurately classifying user activity is only half of the required intervention; the resulting telemetry must be presented visually to overcome cognitive friction and trigger behavioral realization. In human-computer interaction (HCI) research, studies show that passive, static data reporting fails to bridge the “intention-behavior gap,” frequently overwhelming users and leading to intervention blindness [15], [32]. This limitation necessitates a shift toward dynamic, interactive visual analytics. Real-time dashboards that continuously render graphical analytics significantly increase personal awareness and allow for immediate, targeted self-correction the moment a user slips into a state of distraction [16], [22]. By utilizing localized, interactive visualization libraries like Plotly to project active time tracking metrics directly onto a live Eisenhower Matrix representation, a user can synthesize raw digital inputs into an engaging, structured roadmap for habit modification [33].

I. Research Gap and Project Synthesis

Despite significant advancements in User Activity Recognition (UAR) and text categorization, a critical cross-disciplinary research gap remains at the intersection of automated short-text processing, edge computational privacy, and active human-computer interaction (HCI) coaching frameworks. Current software solutions suffer from a strict architectural and functional split:

- **The Passive vs. Active Coaching Gap:** Commercial digital well-being platforms rely almost entirely on “passive reporting” frameworks that summarize historical usage data through retroactive graphs [33]. When active control is attempted, these systems deploy rigid, binary application blocks that induce user frustration and trigger rebound media over-consumption once restrictions expire [7], [10]. There is a definitive lack of intermediate, context-aware systems that utilize real-time persuasive “nudges” to modify behavior without enforcing disruptive, hardcoded application lockouts [14], [37].
- **The Semantic and Contextual Blindness Gap:** Traditional time trackers analyze raw application process titles or generic domain names uniformly, completely missing the underlying cognitive intent of the user [17]. For example, existing architectures uniformly categorize a web browser domain as either wholly productive or completely distracting. They fail to parse high-dimensional, short textual metadata—such as evolving desktop window titles or browser tab headers—leaving them unable to detect when a user is drifting into low-priority tasks

within an otherwise productive application environment [18].

- **The Edge Privacy vs. Computational Overhead Dichotomy:** Advanced natural language processing models capable of parsing short texts often rely heavily on cloud-connected infrastructures or massive language networks [26]. This introduces severe data privacy liabilities, as users are understandably hesitant to exfiltrate highly sensitive, second-by-second desktop window strings to remote servers. Conversely, current local-only tracking mechanisms remain highly simplistic and rule-based because running intensive, non-linear machine learning classifiers directly on a monitored workstation can exhaust local hardware resources and compromise system performance [29], [30].
- **Geographical and Operational Specificity Vacuum:** Existing digital well-being research is primarily tailored to generic Western or highly globalized corporate workflows, creating an empirical vacancy for localized, target-specific interventions [28]. Specifically, within regions experiencing rapid structural shifts toward hybrid education and remote freelancing—such as the Mindanao region in the Philippines—users face a distinct combination of digital fatigue, academic procrastination, and institutional demands for digital literacy [4], [9], [13]. Current literature lacks an empirical framework that actively evaluates how automated edge classifiers perform when subjected to localized, domain-specific student and professional workflow vocabularies [26], [27].

BeeAware directly bridges these interrelated research gaps. Moving beyond the historical charting limits of standard utilities, this system introduces an active, local-only edge architecture that pairs text-vectorization with machine learning to provide immediate cognitive support. To resolve the tension between processing depth and local hardware strain, this study implements a highly optimized, high-dimensional TF-IDF feature vector space evaluated by a regularized Linear Support Vector Classifier (Linear SVC)—benchmarked directly against an ensemble Random Forest framework to identify the mathematical sweet spot for local execution [27], [29].

Furthermore, by mapping these real-time streams onto the psychological decision boundaries of the Eisenhower Matrix, the system converts raw, high-frequency text telemetry into rich visual telemetry—such as task “switching intensity” and quadrant distributions rendered through an interactive Plotly dashboard [3], [16], [25]. Ultimately, by testing this unified framework against real-world scenario sessions validated by the System Usability Scale (SUS), this research provides a scalable, privacy-preserving blueprint for technological habit management explicitly optimized for the modern digital workflows of students and professionals within the region [31], [34].

III. MATERIALS AND METHODS

A. Subsections

IV. RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

V. CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATION

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